

and with its success, many offline bookstores also ventured into the online sphere, which proved to be successful.

In 2005, *www.bazee.com* was bought by popular online wholesale portal *www.ebay.com*. Slowly, after 2005, the trend of online shopping escalated so much that one by one such new platforms as Flipkart, Snapdeal, Yebhi, GadgetsGuru, Myntra, iBibo, MakeMyTrip, Yatra and Craftsvilla started attracting a wide range of people and gained their trust.

In India, the government was happy with the trend and launched its online railway e-commerce platform, IRCTC, in 2002, which offered great convenience to people and allowed them to book train tickets in advance from anywhere, at any time.

Why people prefer online

There are a number of reasons why consumers prefer online channels over traditional brick-and-mortar

ones. Some of these are given below.

Great deals and discounts. Along with availability of thousands of products from various online sellers, online platforms also offer these at great discounts. Discounts are even better if items are bought in bulk.

Not only that, banks have also partnered with e-commerce websites and are offering great cashbacks.

Although some offline shopping stores have also adopted this model, deals available online are better.

No queuing. People's lives have become hectic these days and they want to avoid long queues to buy something. Online shopping offers a hassle-free experience to consumers where there is no queuing.

Get what you want. Search engines are so advanced that consumers can search for any item and can find out where exactly it is available. Also, items that might not be

available in physical stores might be available in online ones, and there is a chance of getting the same at lower prices, too.

Consumer electronic appliances including cellphones have increased the popularity of e-commerce owing to heavy discounts, cashbacks and schemes. Many emerging brands, such as Realme, Honor and Huawei, do not have a physical presence at all.

Helps people compare prices. To buy a trending product, such as a smart speaker or smartphone, online is the place where buyers can find a number of sellers. They have the option to compare prices offered by every seller and on different online platforms, and grab the best deal.

Renowned platforms, such as Flipkart, Amazon, Myntra and Verizon, have a dedicated reviews section for each item and seller along with a quality assurance signature on products. **EFY**

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